

slides

July 5, 2026

1 AI Owners Club: Own Your Own AI

1.0.1 Welcome & Logistics

- **Goal:** Collaborative development and support for owning your own AI.
- **Logistics:** Bring your laptop (if you want to).
- Overview of the 2-hour agenda.

2 The Philosophy of Owning Your AI

2.0.1 Why Local-First AI?

- Personal AI will make Personal Computers actually personal (again).
- This echoes the 1970s homebrew computer era, when we built our own systems due to a lack of choices.
- Comparing the bespoke nature of Web1 and repersonalization of Web3 to the big tech hegemony of Web2.
- Why open-source software (OSS) and “free as in freedom” are crucial to owning your AI.

3 Understanding the Technology

3.0.1 What is an LLM?

- LLMs are pure functions in software systems which are otherwise pretty much just ordinary applications.
- They solve the incredibly difficult problem of understanding and using human language.
- They are computationally expensive.
- There are wide variations in performance with big factors including size, training data & method, and inference algorithm.

4 Analogies for AI

4.0.1 How do we think about AI?

- **The Electricity Analogy:** Andrew Ng: “AI is the new electricity”

And we’re not in the 1880s yet, we’re much much closer to the mid/late 1700s (Lyden Jar) and early 1800s (Voltaic Pile).

<https://library.si.edu/exhibition/fantastic-worlds/body-electric>

5 Analogies for AI

- **Car Ownership**
- Owning an AI is like owning a car.
- The CPU & GPU are engine and turbo. An agent harness is a chassis. This can go on for dashboard, windows, body, etc.
- **But an AI isn't a car**
- It is, or can be, a riding mechanic and tools for modifying the car, and even a car factory too.
<https://connorskelly.substack.com/p/building-plane-while-flying-burnout>

6 Tools and Solutions

6.0.1 Toolset Overview

- **Local Applications:** Jan.ai (Mac, Win, Linux), LMStudio.ai (Mac, Win, Linux), and Osa.ai (Mac).
- **Browser & Server Tools:** WebLLM, Home Assistant, and the Wiki3.ai Web Proxy / IPFS Model Server.

7 Solving the RAG Problem

7.0.1 Adding Document Intelligence to Jan.ai

- **The Problem:** Jan.ai does not support built-in RAG, meaning you can't drop a folder of PDFs into it to ask questions directly.
- **The Solution:** Layer Jan.ai as a clean, privacy-first UI over Haystack and Open WebUI.
- Haystack indexes documents locally, and Open WebUI provides RAG via an OpenAI-compatible API to connect with Jan.ai, keeping all data on your machine.

8 Hands-On Application

8.0.1 Setup & Configuration

- Walkthrough of Jan.ai installation for Mac and Windows.
- Connecting to models using OpenAI-compatible APIs.
- Utilizing free tiers, such as Groq and OpenRouter, and exploring task-based model routing.

9 Expanding Capabilities

9.0.1 Advanced Integration

- Integrating tools and skills like web search and research.
- Exploring Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers and tools.

10 Workshop Practice & Conclusion

10.0.1 Practice & Problem Solving

- **Workshop / Fix It:** Bring your AI ownership issues and questions, and we'll work on them with you.
- **Member Demos:** Show the group what you did or learned in the class.

11 Community & Feedback

11.0.1 What's Next?

- Gathering feedback on what use cases to cover next and how to improve the class.
- This class is Open Source—we are seeking people to localize, customize, and deliver the class themselves.